

I intentionally didn't follow much New Jersey news — I barely even heard about the drones — but on Sunday read this fascinating piece about an attorney general investigation into whether State Police intentionally and dramatically reduced traffic violation enforcement in response to an [AG-sponsored report](#) that found continuing racial bias in traffic stops.

According to the Times, citations for violations — some as serious as drunken driving — went down by 81 percent during an eight-month period beginning in July 2023. That “coincided with an almost immediate uptick in motor vehicle crashes.” [Read more about it here.](#)

It's becoming increasingly clear that there is some kind of power struggle, or at least deep tension, between the Attorney General's Office and the State Police that the AG ultimately oversees. Still, when this report first came out, State Police Superintendent Patrick Callahan said the force would “readily accept and embrace the scrutiny and oversight that comes with serving our communities.”

But a 2023 memo from Troopers union head Wayne Blanchard spoke of “internal and external entities who seemingly wish to see us fail” and reminded his members that “every stop and enforcement action you take will be highly scrutinized,” according to the report.